Session 5: Brand voice and 30-day content plan

Brand Authority & Content Engines

Your outcome

Create a voice playbook, adapt one supported idea into three channels, and plan a realistic 30-day editorial window without assuming daily publication.

Before you begin

Bring two pieces of writing you own and may share, or use invented samples. Choose one audience, one goal, and three channels relevant to that audience. A document and spreadsheet are enough for the lab; no scheduling subscription is required.

Participant details

Name: _____ Cohort: _____
Project / task: _____

Working boundaries

Use fictional or explicitly approved examples. Do not paste private customer, employee, health or financial records into public AI tools. Follow your organization's tool and data rules. Treat outputs as drafts; a person verifies facts and approves external actions.

What to keep

Keep a copy of your inputs, outputs, decisions and revisions. Browser-only drafts may not follow you to another device. Upload the completed resource or share a permitted link through your participant dashboard.

Course coaching

Each cohort participant may request one remote coaching session during the course. Request it inside the platform; your instructor confirms the time. Use the same conversation for time changes.

Lab guide

Follow your instructor or work through these steps using approved tools. A document or manual simulation is acceptable when a connected tool is unavailable; label its status honestly.

Step 1

Build a voice playbook by answering: Who are we helping? What do they need? What do we sound like? Which phrases and claims must we avoid? Save examples, content pillars, and review rules.

Step 2

Turn one source idea into three channel-specific drafts and a visual brief. Keep the underlying facts consistent; adapt the format and call to action to each channel.

Step 3

Follow the six stages: voice brief, drafts, supporting visuals, checks and human approval, scheduling, destination verification. Build a 30-day draft calendar; simulate the scheduling steps unless real publication is explicitly approved.

Worked example — fictional / illustrative

Fictional example: an invented workshop FAQ becomes a short post, an email draft and an FAQ answer. All three preserve the same supplied facts; no testimonial or performance claim is invented. A six-item schedule across 30 days may be more useful than 30 weak posts.

Try the prompt sheet

Use the companion prompt sheet as a starting point, replace bracketed fields and test the result. It is not a guarantee of accuracy or an instruction to publish anything.

Participant worksheet

Complete the fields below. Use the editable Word version if you need more space. Label evidence you have not collected yet as unknown.

Audience / need / communication goal

_____
_____

Three content pillars

_____
_____

Voice traits / do and don't examples / phrases to avoid

_____
_____

Source idea and verified supporting evidence

_____
_____

Channel 1 draft / channel 2 draft / channel 3 draft

_____
_____

Participant worksheet — continued

Complete the fields below. Use the editable Word version if you need more space. Label evidence you have not collected yet as unknown.

Visual brief / rights / alt text

_____
_____

Human edits: facts, permission, voice, links, accessibility

_____
_____

30-day window / cadence / owner / draft and approval status

_____
_____

Simulated or real destination verification / failure handling

_____
_____

Test, challenge and improve

Test 1

Voice: compare a generic draft with a version using your own permitted examples and explicit do/don't rules.

Expected result: _____
Actual result / evidence: _____
Correction or decision: _____

Test 2

Evidence: include an unsupported statistic in a fictional brief. The editor must remove it or label it for verification before approval.

Expected result: _____
Actual result / evidence: _____
Correction or decision: _____

Test 3

Publication: simulate account, date, time zone and status checks. A drafted item is not a scheduled or published item.

Expected result: _____
Actual result / evidence: _____
Correction or decision: _____

Transfer challenge

Have a peer edit one draft against the voice rules. Update the playbook and try a new topic; record whether review becomes easier without reducing accuracy.

Review and submit

Mark each criterion ready, needs revision, or not applicable with a reason. An instructor reviews the evidence; completing a worksheet alone does not establish approval or certificate eligibility.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — The voice playbook includes audience, pillars, do/don't examples, and phrases to avoid.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — One source idea becomes three appropriate channel drafts and a visual brief.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — A human editor checks source support, permissions, voice, links, and accessibility before approving a version.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — The 30-day calendar has a realistic cadence, owners, and explicit draft/approved/scheduled states.

[ ] Ready [ ] Revise [ ] N/A — A test or simulated destination log verifies account, time zone, time, and status; no publishing is assumed.

Submission

Submit under Brand Knowledge Base & Content Calendar in My work. Include your artifact or permitted link, test evidence and notes about what changed. Save a draft if it is not ready for review.

Feedback and follow-through

Feedback received: _____
Change I made: _____
Evidence retested: _____
My next action / owner / review point: _____